

Rational Number Clothesline

Unit 9: Treasure Map Navigator · Lesson 9-4 · EduWonderLab

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9-4 · TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.NS.6

FORMAT Clothesline placement game

TIME 25–30 min

GROUPING Pairs or small groups

TOPIC Rational Numbers on the Number Line

STANDARD 6.NS.6

PREP LEVEL Medium — print long number line and rational number cards

Learning goal *I can place and compare fractions, decimals, and integers on a number line.*

Teacher setup

- Print a long number line and card set per group. Include benchmark cards (0, $\frac{1}{2}$, $-\frac{1}{2}$).
- Students place each rational number, then a partner challenges one placement.
- Require proof for any challenged placement.

Materials

Long paper number line, Rational number cards, Benchmark cards, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Benchmark anchors (0, $\frac{1}{2}$, 1, -1) help placement (SPED).
- Sentence stem: “___ goes between ___ and ___ because ___.”
- ESOL: convert a fraction to a decimal to compare.

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
rational number	número racional	a number that can be written as a fraction
benchmark	punto de referencia	an easy value to compare to

Quick teacher check: *Check Card 3 — comparing negative fractions.*

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Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Your goal: *I can place and compare fractions, decimals, and integers on a number line.*

What you need

Number line, Rational number cards.

How to play

1. Pick a card and decide where the number goes.
2. Place it on the number line using the benchmarks.
3. Order the placed numbers least to greatest.
4. Defend any placement a partner challenges.

Placement Cards

Place each fraction, decimal, and integer on the number line, then compare.

1. Order: $\frac{1}{2}$, $-\frac{1}{2}$, 0, 1	2. 0.75 goes between which two integers?
3. Which is greater: $-\frac{1}{4}$ or $-\frac{3}{4}$?	4. Order: -2, 1.5, -0.5, 0
5. -1.5 goes between which two integers?	6. Which is less: 0.3 or $\frac{1}{2}$?
7. Order: $\frac{1}{4}$, $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{3}{4}$	8. True or false: $-0.5 > -1$?

Record your work (placement + order):

Explain your thinking

Explain how you compare a fraction and a decimal on the same number line.

Sentence frame: ___ goes between ___ and ___ because ___.

★ **Challenge:** Place $-1/4$, 0.5 , and -1 in order. (-1 , $-1/4$, 0.5)

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

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Answers

1. Order: $\frac{1}{2}$, $-\frac{1}{2}$, 0, 1 Answer: $-\frac{1}{2}$, 0, $\frac{1}{2}$, 1	2. 0.75 goes between which two integers? Answer: 0 and 1
3. Which is greater: $-\frac{1}{4}$ or $-\frac{3}{4}$? Answer: $-\frac{1}{4}$	4. Order: -2, 1.5, -0.5, 0 Answer: -2, -0.5, 0, 1.5
5. -1.5 goes between which two integers? Answer: -2 and -1	6. Which is less: 0.3 or $\frac{1}{2}$? Answer: 0.3
7. Order: $\frac{1}{4}$, $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{3}{4}$ Answer: $\frac{1}{4}$, $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{3}{4}$	8. True or false: $-0.5 > -1$? Answer: True

Teaching notes & look-fors

- $-\frac{1}{4}$ is closer to zero than $-\frac{3}{4}$, so $-\frac{1}{4}$ is greater.
- Convert to a common form (decimal) to compare when needed.